GESTALT — VEILBLOOM

Production palette guide • 192 indexed slots • 12 columns × 16 material rows

Palette philosophy

VEILBLOOM is built around deep indigo-violet architecture, sickly jade vegetation and rare acid yellow-green anomalies. Most of the world should sit in dark and middle values; brighter colours are reserved for readable planes, focal points and carefully chosen disturbances. Material identity comes from both hue and value, so grass, stone, skin, metal and glass remain distinct at small sprite sizes.

Identity anchors preserved exactly: Void Ink #17172F; Bruised Violet #34345C; Dusty Lavender #716A9C; Sickly Jade #347A67; Acid Leaf #A9D957.

How to use the files

Import **GESTALT_VEILBLOOM.gpl** into Aseprite using the palette menu / palette import workflow. The GPL is the importable colour list and declares 12 columns. The accompanying **.ase** and **.aseprite** files are indexed-colour swatch reference sprites with the palette embedded; they are not a standalone palette-only file. Open one to inspect the exact 12×16 swatch grid.

Spacer rule: every row has exactly 12 entries. Rows with fewer than 12 usable colours end with opaque #000000 entries. These black slots are layout spacers only and must not be used in game art. In the guide they are labelled BLACK SPACER and their coordinates are shown as RxxCxx. Because Aseprite treats repeated black as ordinary palette colours, the row/column guide is the reliable way to identify them.

Row map

Row	Material family	Usable shades	Black spacer slots
01	Core architecture / violet concrete	10	C11, C12
02	Secondary stone / paving / gravel	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
03	Vegetation / grass / foliage	9	C10, C11, C12
04	Deep vegetation / moss / corrupted growth	9	C10, C11, C12
05	Dirt / soil / paths	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
06	Wood / dead timber	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
07	Metal / gates / railings	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
08	Glass / windows / reflections	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
09	Skin / flesh	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
10	Pale skin / highlights / undertones	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
11	Fabric / uniforms / hospital clothing	10	C11, C12
12	Paper / bone / clinical surfaces	9	C10, C11, C12
13	Blood / injury / restrained narrative accents	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
14	UI darks / text / panel backgrounds	10	C11, C12
15	UI lights / readable text / neutral surfaces	8	C09, C10, C11, C12
16	Unnatural light / mental-state anomalies / distortion	9	C10, C11, C12

Material ramps and colour reference

Hex values are authoritative. Names and purposes below describe intended use, not mandatory semantics.

01 Core architecture / violet concrete

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Void Ink	#17172F	Deepest outlines, recesses and shadow; identity anchor
C02		Night Indigo	#20203D	Deep structural shadow
C03		Bruised Violet	#34345C	Core architecture shadow; identity anchor
C04		Blackened Plum	#41416B	Cool architectural shadow
C05		Deep Slate Violet	#50517D	Dark wall plane
C06		Muted Violet	#605F8D	Mid architectural plane
C07		Dusty Lavender	#716A9C	Lit concrete; identity anchor
C08		Pale Lavender	#8B83B0	Upper wall plane
C09		Faded Lilac Stone	#A69FC4	Pale masonry highlight
C10		Cold Chalk	#C5C0D7	Small concrete glints
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

02 Secondary stone / paving / gravel

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Gravel Black	#24243A	Deep gaps between stones
C02		Blue Violet Gravel	#34354D	Dark gravel shadow
C03		Slate Pebble	#48495F	Main dark paving
C04		Weathered Slate	#5A5B70	Paving midtone
C05		Dusty Stone	#707184	Neutral stone midtone
C06		Pale Grey Violet	#89899B	Lit stone
C07		Chalked Gravel	#A5A4B2	Pale pebble highlight
C08		Frosted Stone	#C1C0CA	Rare tiny glint
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

03 Vegetation / grass / foliage

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Root Green	#172E2D	Deep foliage shadow
C02		Pine Shade	#20453D	Dense grass and tree shadow
C03		Shadow Jade	#286153	Dark leaf mass
C04		Sickly Jade	#347A67	Core vegetation; identity anchor
C05		Moss Jade	#469078	Vegetation midtone
C06		Muted Leaf	#62A487	Lit foliage
C07		Pale Sage	#85BE9C	Grass and leaf highlight
C08		Sick Green Light	#A0CBA0	Small bright foliage accents
C09		Acid Leaf	#A9D957	Rare unnatural highlight; identity anchor
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

04 Deep vegetation / moss / corrupted growth

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Black Moss	#142623	Moss in cracks
C02		Rotten Pine	#1B3830	Deep organic growth
C03		Wet Moss	#285046	Dark moss
C04		Old Jade	#326B58	Main moss shade
C05		Stained Green	#46775C	Moss midtone
C06		Grey Moss	#63866B	Dry moss
C07		Pale Rot	#849B71	Faded organic highlight
C08		Wrong Growth	#9CB45E	Corrupted vegetation
C09		Acid Vein	#B9E35A	Rare anomaly vein
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

05 Dirt / soil / paths

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Soil Void	#211D2B	Deep earth cracks
C02		Dark Plum Soil	#302737	Earth shadow
C03		Damp Earth	#403341	Main dark soil
C04		Muted Earth	#51414B	Soil midtone
C05		Mauve Clay	#66515A	Dry earth
C06		Dusty Clay	#7D666B	Path highlight
C07		Pale Dust	#9A8280	Dry surface
C08		Ashen Soil	#B4A09A	Small pale dirt accents
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

06 Wood / dead timber

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Timber Void	#241D2B	Deep wood cracks
C02		Dark Plum Bark	#342735	Wood shadow
C03		Old Bark	#493744	Weathered timber
C04		Muted Bark	#5B4550	Main wood
C05		Dry Timber	#725660	Wood midtone
C06		Faded Timber	#8A6D75	Lit grain
C07		Dusty Rosewood	#A4888C	Pale worn edge
C08		Bone-Dry Grain	#C0A8A7	Tiny highlight
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

07 Metal / gates / railings

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Iron Void	#171A2B	Gate silhouette
C02		Blue Black Iron	#242A3D	Deep metal shadow
C03		Cold Iron	#343D52	Dark steel
C04		Gate Steel	#4B586C	Main steel
C05		Weathered Steel	#657286	Steel midtone
C06		Pale Steel	#8290A1	Lit bars
C07		Cold Edge	#A7B2BE	Edge highlight
C08		Silver Glint	#CDD3D8	Rare pinprick glint
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

08 Glass / windows / reflections

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Glass Void	#172A32	Dark window
C02		Deep Teal Reflection	#21434A	Glass shadow
C03		Muted Bottle Glass	#2D5A5D	Main dark glass
C04		Cold Green Glass	#3E7776	Glass midtone
C05		Faded Reflection	#639A96	Muted reflection
C06		Pale Glass	#91B8B0	Light reflection
C07		Clouded Glint	#B8D2C9	Bright reflection
C08		Window Spark	#DCE8DF	Tiny glint
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

09 Skin / flesh

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Deep Plum Flesh	#30212E	Deep skin shadow
C02		Brown Plum Shadow	#49313C	Skin shadow
C03		Muted Umber Flesh	#67464D	Shadow flesh
C04		Muted Skin	#8A5E5D	Main skin tone
C05		Warm Mid Flesh	#A97770	Warm midtone
C06		Soft Flesh Light	#C89589	Lit skin
C07		Pale Flesh	#E0B6A6	Skin highlight
C08		Porcelain Warmth	#F0D2C1	Rare strong highlight
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

10 Pale skin / highlights / undertones

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Cool Skin Shadow	#55424C	Cool facial shadow
C02		Dust Rose Shadow	#775A60	Muted undertone
C03		Old Rose	#9A7377	Muted cheek / lip undertone
C04		Warm Blush	#B78D8A	Soft warm undertone
C05		Pale Rose	#D0AAA4	Pale skin
C06		Cream Flesh	#E4C8BB	Light skin highlight
C07		Chalk Flesh	#F1DED2	Bright skin highlight
C08		Overexposed Flesh	#F8E9DC	Rare stark highlight
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

11 Fabric / uniforms / hospital clothing

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Uniform Void	#202032	Deep fabric shadow
C02		Ink Fabric	#303247	Dark uniform
C03		Blue Grey Cloth	#45495F	Uniform mid-shadow
C04		Worn Uniform	#5D6278	Main dark fabric
C05		Faded Uniform	#7A8090	Lit fabric
C06		Pale Hospital Blue	#8B9AAB	Muted hospital clothing
C07		Washed Scrub	#A8B4BD	Pale uniform
C08		Linen Light	#C7D0D0	Fabric highlight
C09		Dirty Linen	#9A918C	Aged fabric
C10		Yellowed Cloth	#B6A995	Old bandage / cloth
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

12 Paper / bone / clinical surfaces

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Paper Void	#2A2837	Paper edge shadow
C02		Old Paper Shadow	#45414A	Aged paper shadow
C03		Grey Paper	#625E68	Paper midtone
C04		Aged Paper	#827C80	Main paper
C05		Yellowed Paper	#A39A91	Old documents
C06		Pale Paper	#C4BFB6	Lit paper
C07		Bone	#DAD4C8	Bone / clinical surface
C08		Chalk White	#EEE9DE	Bright clinical highlight
C09		Sterile Glint	#F8F5EB	Rare near-white
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

13 Blood / injury / restrained narrative accents

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Clotted Shadow	#281D2A	Deep injury shadow
C02		Dried Plum Blood	#452832	Dried blood
C03		Bruise Maroon	#623642	Bruise / blood mid-shadow
C04		Muted Blood	#82464D	Main restrained blood
C05		Old Blood	#A45A5A	Visible blood
C06		Fresh Blood Accent	#C16D6B	Small fresh injury accent
C07		Pale Bruise	#B77D82	Healing / bruised skin
C08		Washed Wound	#D39A98	Rare pale injury detail
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

14 UI darks / text / panel backgrounds

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		UI Void	#111120	Deepest UI background
C02		UI Night	#1B1B31	Main panel background
C03		UI Panel	#292940	Raised panel
C04		UI Border	#41415C	Panel borders
C05		UI Muted Text	#77778F	Disabled / secondary text
C06		UI Secondary Text	#AAA9BC	Secondary readable text
C07		UI Main Text	#DAD9E5	Primary text
C08		UI Bright Text	#F4F2F8	Important text
C09		UI Jade Select	#347A67	Selected state; shared anchor
C10		UI Jade Light	#72B59A	Selected hover / confirmation
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

15 UI lights / readable text / neutral surfaces

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Neutral Deep	#282833	Neutral shadow
C02		Neutral Shadow	#41414A	Dark neutral
C03		Neutral Mid	#66656B	Neutral midtone
C04		Neutral Grey	#8A898D	Neutral surface
C05		Neutral Pale	#B2B0B4	Light neutral
C06		Neutral Light	#D1CFD1	Readable pale surface
C07		Warm White	#E9E5DF	Light UI surface
C08		Near White	#F7F4EF	Bright text / surface
C09		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

16 Unnatural light / mental-state anomalies / distortion

Slot	Swatch	Name	Hex	Purpose
C01		Distortion Void	#1B1838	Wrong-looking shadow
C02		Indigo Glitch	#37365F	Distorted architecture
C03		Cold Wrong Light	#536B7B	Unnatural cool illumination
C04		Jade Shift	#4B9B80	Corrupted green shift
C05		Pale Wrong Green	#81BD80	Unnatural lit surface
C06		Acid Leaf	#A9D957	Core anomaly highlight; identity anchor
C07		Overripe Acid	#C8EB66	Strong anomaly bloom
C08		Sick Light	#DDF18A	Rare perceptual flare
C09		Bleached Anomaly	#F0F4B6	Extremely rare near-white anomaly
C10		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C11		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour
C12		BLACK SPACER — DO NOT USE	#000000	Layout placeholder only; not a game colour

Applying VEILBLOOM to Mereview Hospital

Courtyard grass and trees

Build foliage from Row 03, reserving the brightest sage for sun-facing edges. Use Row 04 for moss, neglected growth and plant masses around cracks; do not use Acid Leaf as ordinary grass.

Dirt roads and gravel

Use Row 05 for packed earth and dirt paths. Row 02 provides stone variation; avoid making every pebble a high-contrast pixel. Keep the darkest soil for cracks and contact shadows.

Concrete walls and security booth

Use Row 01 for the hospital's violet identity, with Row 02 for paving and mixed masonry. Preserve a clear value silhouette against the dark sky and vegetation.

Gate, railings and side door

Shade metal with Row 07. Let a few pale steel pixels describe edges, rather than outlining every bar with the brightest colour. Use Row 06 for worn wooden objects.

Windows and lighting

Row 08 supports dark glass through pale reflections. Use Row 12 for paper, bone and clinical surfaces. Keep glass reflections cool and sparse so windows do not read as luminous cyan.

Characters and clothing

Use Rows 09–10 for flesh and undertones, keeping warm skin distinct from violet walls. Row 11 separates dark uniforms, faded hospital clothing, pale fabric and aged cloth.

UI

Use Row 14 for dark panels, borders, text hierarchy and jade selection states. Row 15 supplies neutral lights. Check contrast at the actual intended display scale.

Psychological distortion

Introduce anomalies locally using Row 16: one window reflection, a patch of foliage, a lit edge or a shadow that breaks the expected ramp. Acid colours should be rare enough to feel significant.

Production rules

• Shade left to right from darkest to lightest within each row; do not assume every ramp must use every colour.

• Choose a material ramp first, then borrow a neighbouring ramp only when it improves the material or the scene's readability.

• Keep ordinary scenes coherent. Psychological horror is strongest when a small, specific violation stands out against a stable baseline.

• Treat #000000 spacer slots as reserved layout entries. Do not use them as outlines or shadows; use Void Ink #17172F instead.

• At small sprite sizes, test the scene in grayscale and at final scale. If a material becomes ambiguous, adjust value separation before adding more hues.

Technical notes and verification status

The GPL file is a text-based GIMP palette with 192 entries and a 12-column declaration. The .ase/.aseprite files are constructed as 8-bit indexed Aseprite-format swatch sprites, 192×256 pixels, with 192 palette entries embedded and each 16×16 swatch assigned its corresponding row-major index. Aseprite/LibreSprite is not installed in this environment, so these files have not been opened in the application for GUI validation. If your Aseprite build rejects the .ase reference sprite, use the GPL palette import and PNG swatch sheet; the palette file is not represented as application-tested.